

1.6 Unit 1, Option D: A World Divided: Communism and Democracy in the 20th Century

Focus

This option concentrates on the theme of contrasting ideologies, with particular emphasis on how Communism developed and, in some societies, succeeded in overthrowing existing authority in the first half of the 20th century. This option also concentrates on how the USA responded to the challenge of Communism during that time and on the development of and challenges to democracy in the USA. Whichever combinations are chosen, this option enables students to understand the importance of ideas and beliefs in the policies developed by states, how and why ideology is frequently a cause of both challenge and conflict, within and between states, and also gives rise to debates about the rights of citizens.

Clarification of content for each topic can be found in *Appendix 1*.

Students entered for Option D are required to study TWO of the topics from D1-D7.

D1 Crises, Tensions and Political Divisions in China, 1900-49

- The last years of Imperial China and the Revolution of 1911-12: the impact of foreigners, reformers and revolutionaries.
- Warlords, Nationalists and Communists, 1912-27: the rule of Yuan Shikai; the May 4th movement; Sun Yat-sen and the revived Guomindang (GMD — Chinese People's Party).
- Nationalist triumph and Communist survival 1927-37: the Shanghai Massacre; the Jiangxi Soviet; the Long March.
- War and civil war, 1937-49: the Japanese assault and its impact; the civil war of 1946-49; reasons for the Communist victory.

D2 Mao's China, 1949-76

- The Government of the People's Republic of China: Mao's authority and ideas; his leading colleagues; the People's Liberation Army; the Hundred Flowers Campaign and its consequences.
- The nature of economic policies: agricultural change in the 1950s and early 1960s; attempts at industrialisation; five-year plans and the Great Leap Forward.
- Social changes, 1949-65: gender, class and culture.

**D3 Russia in
Revolution,
1881-1924:
From Autocracy
to Dictatorship**

- The challenges to the Tsarist state, 1881-1906: nature of the regime; economic and social changes; opposition parties; the 1905 revolution.
- Tsarism's last chance, 1906-1917: the Dumas; Stolypin; the impact of War; the downfall of the Romanovs.
- February to October 1917: the Provisional Government and the Bolshevik coup.
- Holding on to and consolidating power, 1918-24: civil war; changing economic policies; creating the Soviet state.

**D4 Stalin's Russia,
1924-53**

- The struggle for power — the making of the new *vozhds* 1924-29: personalities and policies.
- Transforming the Soviet Union: the collectivisation of agriculture and its social and economic impact; industrialisation and its economic and social impact; the three five-year plans; changing social policies.
- Persecution and control: the origins and course of the purges; culture and the arts in the service of a totalitarian regime.
- The making of a superpower: the Great Patriotic War; devastation; war production; victory.

**D5 Pursuing Life
and Liberty:
Equality in the
USA, 1945-68**

- The social and economic position of black citizens in the USA in the 1940s and early 1950s: the nature and extent of discrimination and segregation; signs of change by 1955.
- Martin Luther King and peaceful protest.
- Black power and the use of violence; the extent to which equality had been achieved by 1968.
- The changing economic and social environment of the 1960s: the position of other ethnic minorities.

**D6 Ideology,
Conflict and
Retreat: the
USA in Asia,
1950-73**

- The Korean War, 1950-53: causes, course and consequences.
- The ideological struggle in south east Asia in the early 1950s: the French in Vietnam; the British in Malaysia; US concerns; the Southeast Asia Treaty Organization (SEATO).
- Growing US participation in Vietnam, 1954-68: Eisenhower, Kennedy and Johnson.
- The Nixon Presidency and the withdrawal of US forces, 1969-73: the reaction to the Vietnam War in the USA and the changing international diplomatic context.